

Staff Supervision & Performance Management

SECTION 1: PURPOSE, SCOPE & SUPERVISION FRAMEWORK

1 PURPOSE

This policy establishes the framework for formal staff supervision and performance management at Chosanta Management. Effective supervision is essential to safeguarding, professional development, staff wellbeing, and the delivery of high-quality, person-centred care. It is aligned to the following legislative and regulatory standards:

- ✓ **HIQA National Standards for Children's Residential Centres 2018, Standard 6 — Responsive Workforce (6.3):** Providers must ensure staff receive regular formal supervision from qualified supervisors; signed supervision records must be maintained; performance must be formally appraised at least annually; a culture of reflective practice and learning must be promoted
- ✓ **Child Care (Standards in Children's Residential Centres) Regulations 2018 (S.I. No. 674/2017), Regulation 15 (Staffing):** Registered provider must ensure staff numbers, qualifications, and skill mix are appropriate to the assessed needs of children and the Statement of Purpose
- ✓ **Regulation 16 (Staff Training and Development):** Registered provider must ensure all staff have access to appropriate training and development to carry out their duties competently
- ✓ **National Vetting Bureau (Children and Vulnerable Persons) Acts 2012–2016:** All staff must have current Garda vetting; Tusla-regulated services require re-vetting every 3 years
- ✓ **Children First Act 2015:** All staff are mandated persons; supervision must ensure safeguarding obligations are understood and met

2 SCOPE

- ✓ All staff employed by Chosanta Management — including full-time, part-time, relief, and agency workers
- ✓ Volunteers and students on placement who have direct contact with residents or service users
- ✓ The Person in Charge (PIC), supervisors, team leaders, and management staff (who receive supervision from the Director)
- ✓ Supervision applies to all roles — care staff, administrative staff, ancillary staff, and contracted professionals

3 SUPERVISION FRAMEWORK

Chosanta Management operates a structured supervision system comprising three types of supervision:

- ✓ **Formal (1:1) Supervision:** Scheduled, private, documented sessions between a staff member and their line manager/supervisor — covering workload, safeguarding, development, wellbeing, and compliance
- ✓ **Informal / Day-to-Day Supervision:** Ongoing support, guidance, and observation provided by senior staff during shifts — includes modelling good practice, immediate feedback, and on-the-spot coaching
- ✓ **Group Supervision / Team Meetings:** Regular team meetings for case discussion, policy updates, peer learning, and collective problem-solving — documented with minutes and action points

4 SUPERVISION FREQUENCY

Staff Category	Supervision Frequency	Supervisor
New staff (during probation)	Monthly (minimum)	PIC / Line Manager
Care staff (post-probation)	Every 6–8 weeks	PIC / Senior Staff
Senior / Team Leaders	Every 6–8 weeks	PIC / Director
Person in Charge (PIC)	Every 6–8 weeks	Director
Relief / agency staff	After every 5 shifts (minimum)	PIC / Senior Staff
Volunteers / students	Fortnightly	Designated Supervisor

Staff Supervision & Performance Management

SECTION 2: SUPERVISION CONTENT & RESPONSIBILITIES

5 SUPERVISION SESSION CONTENT

Each formal supervision session should cover the following areas:

- ✓ **Review of previous actions:** Progress on agreed actions from the last supervision session
- ✓ **Safeguarding:** Any safeguarding concerns, observations, or disclosures — including review of incident reports involving the staff member
- ✓ **Resident care:** Quality of care delivery, adherence to personal plans, resident feedback, and person-centred practice
- ✓ **Workload & practice:** Current caseload, shift patterns, documentation standards, and compliance with policies
- ✓ **Professional development:** Training needs, career goals, qualifications, and development opportunities
- ✓ **Wellbeing:** Staff member's physical and emotional health, work-life balance, and any support needs
- ✓ **Organisational updates:** Policy changes, regulatory updates, team issues, and operational matters
- ✓ **Actions & targets:** Clear, measurable actions agreed for the next supervision period with named responsibility and deadlines

6 RESPONSIBILITIES

Supervisor Responsibilities:

- ✓ Schedule and protect supervision time — sessions should not be routinely cancelled or rescheduled
- ✓ Create a safe, confidential environment where staff feel able to raise concerns without fear of reprisal
- ✓ Provide constructive feedback — acknowledge good practice and address performance concerns directly
- ✓ Complete and sign supervision records within 5 working days; provide a copy to the staff member
- ✓ Escalate safeguarding concerns or serious performance issues to the PIC/Director immediately

Staff Member Responsibilities:

- ✓ Attend supervision sessions as scheduled; notify supervisor in advance if unable to attend
- ✓ Prepare for sessions — reflect on practice, identify areas of concern or development, and bring relevant examples
- ✓ Engage openly and honestly in the supervision process
- ✓ Complete agreed actions within the specified timeframes
- ✓ Read, sign, and retain a copy of supervision records
- ✓ Request additional supervision if experiencing difficulties or concerns between scheduled sessions

Staff Supervision & Performance Management

SECTION 3: PERFORMANCE APPRAISAL & REFLECTIVE PRACTICE

7 ANNUAL PERFORMANCE APPRAISAL

All staff participate in a formal annual performance appraisal in addition to regular supervision. The annual appraisal is a comprehensive review of the staff member's performance, development, and contribution to the service over the preceding 12-month period.

The annual appraisal process includes:

- ✓ **Self-assessment:** Staff member completes a self-reflection form covering achievements, challenges, learning, and development goals
- ✓ **Supervisor assessment:** Line manager reviews performance against role expectations, supervision records, training compliance, incident involvement, and feedback from colleagues/residents
- ✓ **Joint meeting:** A collaborative discussion to agree on a performance rating, identify strengths and areas for improvement, and set objectives for the coming year
- ✓ **Personal Development Plan (PDP):** A written plan outlining training needs, career aspirations, and specific development actions with timelines
- ✓ **Sign-off:** Both parties sign the appraisal record; copies retained on the personnel file and with the staff member

8 REFLECTIVE PRACTICE

Chosanta Management promotes reflective practice as a core professional standard. Reflective practice encourages staff to critically examine their own work, learn from experiences, and continuously improve the quality of care they deliver.

- ✓ Staff are encouraged to maintain a reflective practice journal or log — noting significant events, learning moments, and areas for development
- ✓ Reflective practice is integrated into supervision sessions — supervisors invite staff to discuss specific situations, consider alternative approaches, and identify lessons learned
- ✓ Group reflective sessions may be held following critical incidents, complaints, or significant events — facilitated by a senior staff member or external facilitator
- ✓ Reflective practice records are confidential unless they contain safeguarding concerns or evidence of malpractice

9 MANAGING UNDERPERFORMANCE

- ✓ **Early intervention:** Performance concerns are addressed at the earliest opportunity through informal feedback and additional supervision support
- ✓ **Performance Improvement Plan (PIP):** Where concerns persist, a formal PIP is implemented — specifying the performance gap, expected standards, support provided, measurable targets, and review dates
- ✓ **Escalation:** If improvement is not achieved within the PIP timeframe, the matter is escalated through the disciplinary procedure — with HR involvement and documentation at every stage
- ✓ **Safeguarding override:** Where underperformance poses an immediate risk to resident safety, the staff member may be suspended or redeployed pending investigation — irrespective of PIP status

Staff Supervision & Performance Management

SECTION 4: SUPERVISION RECORD TEMPLATE

✓ FORMAL SUPERVISION RECORD

Field	Details
Staff Member Name	
Role / Job Title	
Supervisor Name	
Date of Supervision	
Location	
Next Supervision Due	

A DISCUSSION AREAS

Topic	Discussion Notes
Review of Previous Actions	
Safeguarding Concerns	
Resident Care & Practice	
Workload & Compliance	
Training & Development	
Staff Wellbeing	
Organisational Updates	

B AGREED ACTIONS

Action	Responsible	Deadline	Status

Staff Member Signature: _____ Date: _____

Supervisor Signature: _____ Date: _____

Comments / Concerns Raised: _____

Legislative Basis: HIQA National Standards 2018 (Standard 6, 6.3) · S.I. 674/2017 (Reg. 15 & 16) · National Vetting Bureau Acts 2012–2016 · Children First Act 2015

Policy Ref: CM-SSP-001 | **Review Date:** May 2027 | **Version:** 2.0